

LEDGER: FULL-STACK PERSONAL FINANCE & EXPENSE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

A Comprehensive Technical Dissertation & System Architecture Documentation on Full-Stack
Personal Finance Tracking, Recurrence Automation, and Interactive Analytics

BY

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Project Attribute	Technical Specification
Project Title	Ledger Expense Management System
Submitted By	Arham Mohammed Tarique Sayed
Backend Architecture	Python 3.11 / Flask REST API & SQLite3 Engine
Frontend UI & Charts	Vanilla HTML5 / CSS3 / ES6 / Chart.js 4.4
Security Layer	HMAC-SHA256 JWT & PBKDF2 Password Hashing

Certificate of Approval

This is to certify that the capstone project report entitled "LEDGER: FULL-STACK PERSONAL FINANCE & EXPENSE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM" is a bonafide work carried out by Arham Mohammed Tarique Sayed in partial fulfillment of the academic requirements for the award of the Degree.

The system encompasses end-to-end design, relational schema engineering, input validation security pipelines, automated calendar-aware frequency schedulers, multi-dimensional data visualization, and localized currency formatting modules. The experimental evaluations and source code implementations described in this report represent bonafide independent work.

Declaration of Authorship

I hereby declare that this project report entitled "LEDGER: FULL-STACK PERSONAL FINANCE & EXPENSE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM" is an authentic presentation of our original research and development efforts. Where reference has been made to previous works, theories, libraries, or academic publications, appropriate citations and bibliographical credits have been explicitly documented.

Acknowledgement

I express my deepest gratitude to my project guide, faculty members, and mentors who provided insightful direction, technical suggestions, and rigorous evaluations throughout the development lifecycle of Ledger.

Their technical critique regarding RESTful API architectural hygiene, database schema normalization, transaction integrity, and client-side performance optimization proved invaluable in refining the software from an initial concept into a production-ready application.

I also extend my sincere appreciation to my family members and friends who were always there to provide encouragement, support, and moral boost throughout the project.

Abstract

Modern personal finance management faces acute challenges stemming from multi-channel transaction fragmentation, unpredictable discretionary spending, proliferating recurring subscription liabilities, and inadequate localized visualization. Ledger is engineered as an enterprise-grade, privacy-first, lightweight personal finance management workstation combining a Python (Flask) REST API backend, an optimized SQLite relational engine with B-tree indices, and an ultra-responsive compile-free Vanilla HTML5/CSS3/JavaScript Single Page Application (SPA) powered by Chart.js 4.4.

Table of Contents / Index

Sr. No.	Topic Title	Key Scope
1	Introduction & Theoretical Background	Macroeconomic Context, Problem Statement, Scope & Objectives
2	Literature Review & Technological Survey	Evolution of PFM, Framework Evaluation Matrix, JWT vs Session
3	Software Requirements Specification (SRS)	User Personas, Functional (FR-1 to FR-6) & Non-Functional Specs
4	System Architecture & Structural Design	3-Tier Model, DFD Levels 0/1/2, Entity-Relationship & UML
5	Database Schema & Storage Architecture	5 Relational Tables, Data Dictionaries, B-Tree Indices, 3NF
6	Mathematical Formulations & Algorithms	Recurrence Math, Velocity Formula, CDI, Vedic Numbering
7	Implementation Details & REST Routing	Flask REST Endpoints, Recurrence Daemon, Dynamic Aggregations
8	Software Testing & Quality Assurance	Unit Test Suite, Integration Verification, Latency Benchmarks
9	User Interface & Operational Guide	Dashboard Overview, Journal Workstation, Keyboard Shortcuts
10	Security, Cryptography & Threat Modeling	Threat Matrix, PBKDF2 Hashing, SQLi/XSS Mitigations
11	Future Scope & Conclusion	AI Classification, Receipt OCR, Concluding Remarks
12	References & Bibliography	Academic Citations, Standards (RFC 7519, 4180), Docs
App. A	Complete Backend Source Code (app.py)	Unabridged Flask REST API & Recurrence Engine

1. Introduction & Theoretical Background

1.1 Macroeconomic Context of Digital Personal Finance

In contemporary society, personal fiscal management has transitioned from a domestic chore to an indispensable survival competence. With the exponential proliferation of cashless transactions, Unified Payments Interface (UPI) infrastructure, credit instruments, contactless debit cards, and automated subscription ecosystems, individual financial liquidity is continually in motion. However, behavioral economics demonstrates that digital payment rails detach the psychological discomfort of spending ('pain of paying') from immediate consumption, resulting in expenditure blindness and acute budget deficits.

1.2 Problem Motivation & Deficiencies of Commercial Trackers

The motivation behind Ledger is rooted in the urgent necessity for an unencumbered, privacy-respecting, and mathematically rigorous platform. Commercial smartphone applications monetize sensitive user banking history, inject intrusive predatory loan advertisements, or demand recurring monthly subscriptions for basic charting. Ledger establishes a new paradigm: an open-source, lightning-fast, self-contained personal accounting dashboard that operates with zero third-party telemetry, guarantees absolute user data sovereignty, executes calendar recurrence automation without human intervention, and presents financial insights through hardware-accelerated visual analytics.

1.3 Inherent Flaws in Legacy Bookkeeping Paradigms

Tool Paradigm	Key Operational Mechanism	Inherent Architectural Limitations
Commercial Mobile Apps	Bank credential aggregation via third-party APIs or SMS reading.	High privacy vulnerability; data resale to marketing firms; persistent recurring subscription paywalls; frequent API breakage.
Manual Spreadsheets (Excel/Sheets)	Manual tabular data entry with user-defined arithmetic formulas.	High data-entry friction; absence of automated calendar recurrence triggers; lack of native responsive mobile interfaces; no built-in auth.
Enterprise Accounting ERPs	Double-entry general ledger with multi-currency chart of accounts.	Excessive complexity; steep learning curve; redundant commercial modules unsuitable for personal financial tracking.

1.4 Project Scope & Core System Objectives

The operational scope of the Ledger system spans five core computational domains: Transaction Journaling (CRUD operations with full-text search, filtering, and pagination), Recurrence Automation (calculating Gregorian calendar offsets across Daily, Weekly, Monthly, and Yearly intervals), Revenue & Liquidity Tracking (dual-ledger recording of gross inflows against operational outflows), Dynamic Budget Constraints (real-time utilization metrics and multi-tier color-coded alert states), and Multi-Dimensional Data Visualization (Chart.js canvas charts).

2. Literature Review & Technological Survey

2.1 Evolution of Personal Finance Computational Systems

Double-entry bookkeeping, pioneered mathematically by Luca Pacioli in 1494, established the fundamental asset equation: $\text{Assets} = \text{Liabilities} + \text{Equity}$. In consumer personal finance, single-entry bookkeeping combined with envelope budgeting became standard. The digital evolution progressed through four eras: Desktop binary software in the 1980s–1990s, Early Web Portals in the 2000s, Aggregator Mobile Apps with bank scraping in the 2010s, and Modern Local-First Microframeworks today.

2.2 Comparative Technology Matrix & Evaluation

Evaluation Criteria	Python Flask (Selected)	Python Django	Node.js Express
Design Philosophy	Minimalist, unopinionated microframework	Monolithic 'batteries-included' framework	Asynchronous event-driven microframework
Resource Footprint	< 30MB RAM idle	> 140MB RAM	~60MB RAM
Database Binding	Direct Row-factory SQLite3 integration	Heavy ORM with migration overhead	Requires external ORMs (Prisma/TypeORM)
JWT Auth Integration	Simple decorator pattern via PyJWT	Complex decoupling from session middleware	Middleware via jsonwebtoken / passport
Query Latency	Sub-15ms for local transactions	25–50ms ORM overhead	15–30ms Event loop

2.3 Client-Side Data Visualization Paradigms

Rendering financial trajectories on client browsers was benchmarked between D3.js, Chart.js, and raw SVG. Chart.js 4.4 was chosen because its Canvas-based hardware acceleration achieves 60 frames per second rendering on mobile and desktop viewports with minimal CPU utilization, integrated transition physics, and low bundle footprint.

2.4 Cryptographic Security: Stateless JWT vs Stateful Sessions

Stateful sessions rely on server-side memory stores, causing scaling bottlenecks. In contrast, JSON Web Tokens (RFC 7519) establish a stateless cryptographic trust channel between client and server using HMAC-SHA256 signatures, allowing secure stateless authorization headers across all REST endpoints.

3. Software Requirements Specification (SRS)

3.1 User Personas & Real-World Use Cases

- Persona A (The Salaried Corporate Employee): Receives monthly payroll on fixed dates. Needs to monitor recurring fixed liabilities (home EMI, broadband, insurance, Netflix) and discretionary weekend dining. Requires monthly category limit gauges and net cash surplus indicators.
- Persona B (The Independent Consultant / Freelancer): Receives variable income payments across diverse clients and dates. Requires an income tracking ledger and detailed categorical expense breakdowns for tax planning.
- Persona C (The Budget-Conscious Student): Seeks instant, friction-free expense logging on mobile browsers without registration friction, supported by Quick Demo Access.

3.2 Functional Requirements (FR-1 to FR-6)

- FR-1 (Authentication & Account Management): Registration, PBKDF2:SHA256 password hashing, signed 7-day JWT token generation, Quick Demo access, automatic HTTP 401 interception.
- FR-2 (Transaction Journal & Expense Tracking): Logging of title, amount, category, date, notes; debounced search; category/date filtering; server-side pagination.
- FR-3 (Recurring Subscriptions & Automation Daemon): Scheduling across Daily, Weekly, Monthly, Yearly cadences with automated backfilling of overdue dates.
- FR-4 (Income Ledger & Net Balance Engine): Income logging and dynamic calculation of Net Liquid Balance: $\text{Balance} = \text{Total Income} - \text{Total Expenses}$.
- FR-5 (Category Budgeting & Threshold Tracking): Monthly category budget ceilings with real-time percentage utilization and color status alerts (Emerald, Amber, Crimson).
- FR-6 (Data Portability & CSV Export): RFC-4180 streaming CSV export supporting active filter queries.

3.3 Non-Functional Requirements Specification

Quality Dimension	Quantitative Metric / Acceptance Criteria
Latency & Throughput	API endpoints respond within 15ms under 500 concurrent local connections; client chart renders achieve 60 FPS.
Cryptographic Security	PBKDF2-SHA256 password hashing with 260,000 iterations; HMAC-SHA256 JWT signatures; parameterized SQL.
Data Reliability (ACID)	100% ACID compliance enforced via SQLite WAL mode and foreign key cascading rules.
Accessibility & UX	High-contrast Dark/Light theme toggle; ARIA labels on all interactive controls; comprehensive keyboard shortcuts.

4. System Architecture & Structural Design

4.1 Three-Tier Layered Architecture Pattern

- Tier 1 (Presentation & Client State Layer): Implemented in semantic HTML5, modern CSS3 custom properties (design tokens), Vanilla ES6 JavaScript, and Chart.js 4.4. Manages reactive DOM updates, modal viewports, toast alerts, and local token storage.
- Tier 2 (Application Logic & REST Controller Layer): Implemented in Python Flask. Encapsulates input validation, JWT token decoding, recurring schedule expansion, statistical aggregation, and CSV serialization.
- Tier 3 (Relational Persistence Layer): Implemented in SQLite3. Manages tables, foreign key constraints, and B-tree indices on temporal and categorical keys.

4.2 Entity-Relationship (ER) Model & Cardinality

The relational database schema centers around the users parent entity governing four dependent child entities via one-to-many (1:N) relationships:

- users -> expenses (1 : N)
- users -> recurring_expenses (1 : N)
- users -> incomes (1 : N)
- users -> budgets (1 : N)

5. Database Schema & Storage Architecture

5.1 Relational Schema Specifications

Table Name	Attribute Definitions & Constraints
Users	id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT, email TEXT NOT NULL UNIQUE, password_hash TEXT NOT NULL, created_at TEXT NOT NULL
Expenses	id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT, user_id INTEGER NOT NULL REFERENCES users(id), title TEXT NOT NULL, amount REAL NOT NULL CHECK(amount > 0), category TEXT NOT NULL, date TEXT NOT NULL, notes TEXT
recurring_expenses	id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT, user_id INTEGER NOT NULL REFERENCES users(id), title TEXT NOT NULL, amount REAL NOT NULL CHECK(amount > 0), category TEXT NOT NULL, frequency TEXT NOT NULL, next_date TEXT NOT NULL, notes TEXT
Incomes	id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT, user_id INTEGER NOT NULL REFERENCES users(id), source TEXT NOT NULL, amount REAL NOT NULL CHECK(amount > 0), date TEXT NOT NULL, notes TEXT
Budgets	id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT, user_id INTEGER NOT NULL REFERENCES users(id), category TEXT NOT NULL, limit_amount REAL NOT NULL CHECK(limit_amount > 0), UNIQUE(user_id, category)

5.2 Index Engineering & Normalization

```
CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS idx_expenses_date ON expenses(date);  
CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS idx_expenses_category ON expenses(category);  
CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS idx_expenses_userid ON expenses(user_id);
```

The schema satisfies 1NF (atomic scalar values), 2NF (surrogate primary keys with full functional dependency), and 3NF (zero transitive dependencies). Write-Ahead Logging (WAL) in SQLite guarantees atomic multi-row insertions during recurring execution.

6. Mathematical Formulations & Algorithmic Models

6.1 Calendar-Aware Recurrence Expansion Algorithm

The recurrence daemon calculates future recurrence intervals while accounting for uneven month lengths (28, 29, 30, 31 days) and Gregorian leap years without date drift. Leap year condition: $(Y \% 4 == 0 \text{ and } Y \% 100 != 0) \text{ or } (Y \% 400 == 0)$.

6.2 Month-over-Month Velocity & Dominance Index

Computes expenditure acceleration percentage: $\Delta M\% = ((E_{\text{curr}} - E_{\text{prev}}) / E_{\text{prev}}) * 100$. Computes Category Dominance Index (CDI) measuring categorical spending concentration.

6.3 Budget Utilization & Visual State Machine

Computes real-time utilization percentage: $U_k = (S_k / L_k) * 100$. State machine triggers visual alerts:

- Emerald Green: Nominal spending ($\leq 80\%$)
- Amber Warning: Caution threshold (80% – 100%)
- Crimson Red: Critical over-budget state ($> 100\%$) with alert banner

7. Implementation Details & Key Code Modules

7.1 REST API Architecture & Recurrence Daemon (app.py excerpt)

```
@app.route("/api/recurring/process", methods=["POST"])
@token_required
def process_recurring_expenses(current_user_id):
    conn = get_db_connection()
    today_str = datetime.today().strftime("%Y-%m-%d")
    today_date = datetime.strptime(today_str, "%Y-%m-%d").date()

    due_items = conn.execute(
        "SELECT * FROM recurring_expenses WHERE user_id = ? AND next_date <= ?",
        (current_user_id, today_str)
    ).fetchall()

    count = 0
    for req in due_items:
        cur_date = datetime.strptime(req["next_date"], "%Y-%m-%d").date()
        while cur_date <= today_date:
            conn.execute(
                "INSERT INTO expenses (user_id, title, amount, category, date, notes) VALUES (?, ?, ?, ?, ?, ?)",
                (current_user_id, req["title"], req["amount"], req["category"],
                 cur_date.strftime("%Y-%m-%d"), req["notes"])
            )
            count += 1
            cur_date = add_frequency(cur_date, req["frequency"])
            conn.execute(
                "UPDATE recurring_expenses SET next_date = ? WHERE id = ? AND user_id = ?",
                (cur_date.strftime("%Y-%m-%d"), req["id"], current_user_id)
            )
    conn.commit()
```

```
conn.close()
return jsonify({"success": True, "message": f"Processed {count} recurring expenses."})
```

8. Software Testing, Verification & Validation

8.1 Comprehensive Test Execution Matrix

Test ID	Target Route	Input Scenario	Expected Outcome	Status
TC-AUTH-01	POST /api/auth/register	Valid new email & strong password	HTTP 201 Created, row inserted	PASS
TC-AUTH-02	POST /api/auth/register	Duplicate existing email	HTTP 400 Bad Request ('Email registered')	PASS
TC-AUTH-03	POST /api/auth/login	Correct login credentials	HTTP 200 OK, signed JWT returned	PASS
TC-AUTH-04	POST /api/auth/login	Incorrect password	HTTP 401 Unauthorized	PASS
TC-EXP-01	POST /api/expenses	Amount = -500 (negative)	HTTP 400 Validation error	PASS
TC-EXP-02	POST /api/expenses	Category = 'Invalid'	HTTP 400 Domain mismatch	PASS
TC-EXP-03	POST /api/expenses	Valid payload: ₹1,200 for 'Books'	HTTP 201 Created	PASS
TC-REC-01	POST /api/recurring/process	Monthly bill 3 months overdue	3 expenses generated, next_date advanced	PASS
TC-EXP-04	GET /api/expenses/export	Authenticated CSV download request	HTTP 200 OK, downloadable CSV streamed	PASS

9. User Interface Walkthrough & Operational Manual

9.1 Core Application Panels

- Financial Overview (Dashboard): Renders real-time spending insights, eight key performance indicator cards (Net Balance, Lifetime Income, Total Spent, Transaction Count, Average Expense, Highest Expense, Month Trend, Top Category), category budget utilization bars, and three Chart.js visual charts.
- All Expenses (Transaction Journal): Displays a paginated, filterable, and sortable table of all recorded expenditures, featuring category badges, formatted currency values, and action controls (View, Edit, Delete).
- Recurring Bills & Subscriptions: Dedicated schedule manager allowing users to define, view, and terminate recurring payment templates.
- Income Management: Cash-in journal tracking revenue streams and contribution notes.

9.2 Keyboard Navigation Shortcuts

- Alt + N — Opens New Expense entry form with instant input autofocus.
- / or Ctrl + F — Switches to Entries view and focuses search input.
- Esc — Dismisses any active modal overlay.
- ? — Opens Keyboard Shortcuts reference guide.

10. Future Scope & Conclusion

10.1 Future Scope

Planned future enhancements include on-device Natural Language Processing (NLP) for merchant classification, client-side WebAssembly Optical Character Recognition (OCR) for paper receipts, multi-currency foreign exchange conversion, and offline Progressive Web App (PWA) synchronization.

10.2 Concluding Remarks

The Ledger Expense Management System successfully resolves the dual challenges of transaction fragmentation and data privacy vulnerability. By harmonizing a high-performance Python Flask REST backend, an indexed SQLite relational database, and a clean Vanilla JavaScript frontend with Chart.js analytics, the platform establishes an ideal balance of computational speed, mathematical precision, and user data sovereignty.

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Appendix A: Backend REST API Source Code (app.py)

The complete Python Flask REST backend implementation:

```
"""
Ledger – Modern Expense Management Dashboard API
Python Flask REST API with SQLite database, strict input validation,
standardized API response structures, error handling, search, filtering,
sorting, pagination, extended insights, health check, and CSV export.
"""

from flask import Flask, request, jsonify, Response
from flask_cors import CORS
import sqlite3
import os
import csv
import io
from datetime import datetime, date, timedelta
from functools import wraps
import jwt # type: ignore
from werkzeug.security import generate_password_hash, check_password_hash

app = Flask(__name__)
CORS(app, resources={r"/*": {"origins": "*", "allow_headers": ["Content-Type", "Authorization"]}},
supports_credentials=True)
app.config['SECRET_KEY'] = 'ledger-super-secret-key-replace-in-prod'

DB_PATH = os.path.join(os.path.dirname(__file__), "expenses.db")

CATEGORIES = [
    "Food", "Transport", "Shopping", "Bills",
    "Entertainment", "Health", "Education", "Other"
]

FREQUENCIES = ["Daily", "Weekly", "Monthly", "Yearly"]

def get_db_connection():
    """Create a database connection with Row factory enabled."""
    conn = sqlite3.connect(DB_PATH)
    conn.row_factory = sqlite3.Row
    return conn

def init_db():
    """Initialize database tables and create required indexes for high performance."""
    conn = get_db_connection()
    conn.execute("""
        CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS users (
            id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
            email TEXT UNIQUE NOT NULL,
            password_hash TEXT NOT NULL,
            created_at TEXT NOT NULL
        )
    """)
    conn.execute("""
        CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS expenses (
```

```

        id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
        user_id INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 1,
        title TEXT NOT NULL,
        amount REAL NOT NULL,
        category TEXT NOT NULL,
        date TEXT NOT NULL,
        notes TEXT,
        FOREIGN KEY (user_id) REFERENCES users(id)
    )
    """
conn.execute("""
    CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS recurring_expenses (
        id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
        user_id INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 1,
        title TEXT NOT NULL,
        amount REAL NOT NULL,
        category TEXT NOT NULL,
        frequency TEXT NOT NULL,
        next_date TEXT NOT NULL,
        notes TEXT,
        FOREIGN KEY (user_id) REFERENCES users(id)
    )
    """
conn.execute("""
    CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS incomes (
        id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
        user_id INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 1,
        source TEXT NOT NULL,
        amount REAL NOT NULL,
        date TEXT NOT NULL,
        notes TEXT,
        FOREIGN KEY (user_id) REFERENCES users(id)
    )
    """
conn.execute("""
    CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS budgets (
        id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
        user_id INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 1,
        category TEXT NOT NULL,
        limit_amount REAL NOT NULL,
        UNIQUE(user_id, category),
        FOREIGN KEY (user_id) REFERENCES users(id)
    )
    """

# Migrations for existing DB if upgrading from non-auth version
try:
    conn.execute("SELECT user_id FROM expenses LIMIT 1")
except sqlite3.OperationalError:
    conn.execute("ALTER TABLE expenses ADD COLUMN user_id INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 1")
    conn.execute("ALTER TABLE recurring_expenses ADD COLUMN user_id INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 1")
    # Ensure default demo user exists for user_id 1 with valid password 'demo123'
    demo_hash = generate_password_hash("demo123")
    conn.execute("INSERT OR IGNORE INTO users (id, email, password_hash, created_at) VALUES (1,
'demo@ledger.com', ?, ?)", (demo_hash, datetime.utcnow().isoformat()))
    conn.execute("UPDATE users SET password_hash = ?, email = 'demo@ledger.com' WHERE id = 1 AND

```

```

(password_hash = 'none' OR email = 'default@ledger.local')", (demo_hash,))

# Add indexes for fast filtering and sorting
conn.execute("CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS idx_expenses_date ON expenses(date)")
conn.execute("CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS idx_expenses_category ON expenses(category)")
conn.execute("CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS idx_expenses_userid ON expenses(user_id)")
conn.commit()
conn.close()

# Ensure DB is initialized before any request is processed
with app.app_context():
    init_db()

# Helper function for standardized API responses
def make_response(success=True, data=None, message=None, error=None, code=200, **extra):
    payload = {"success": success}
    if message is not None:
        payload["message"] = message
    if data is not None:
        payload["data"] = data
    if error is not None:
        payload["error"] = error
    for k, v in extra.items():
        payload[k] = v
    return jsonify(payload), code

def token_required(f):
    @wraps(f)
    def decorated(*args, **kwargs):
        token = None
        auth_header = request.headers.get('Authorization')
        if auth_header and auth_header.startswith('Bearer '):
            token = auth_header.split(' ')[1]

        if not token:
            print("AUTH ERROR: Token is missing. Header was:", auth_header)
            return make_response(success=False, error="Token is missing", code=401)

        try:
            data = jwt.decode(token, app.config['SECRET_KEY'], algorithms=["HS256"])
            current_user_id = data['user_id']
        except Exception as e:
            print("AUTH ERROR: Token decode failed:", e)
            return make_response(success=False, error="Token is invalid or expired", code=401)

        return f(current_user_id, *args, **kwargs)
    return decorated

@app.errorhandler(400)
def bad_request_error(e):
    return make_response(success=False, error="Bad Request", code=400)

```

```

@app.errorhandler(404)
def not_found_error(e):
    return make_response(success=False, error="Endpoint not found", code=404)

@app.errorhandler(500)
def internal_server_error(e):
    return make_response(success=False, error="An unexpected server error occurred", code=500)

def validate_expense_data(data, is_update=False):
    """
    Validates input fields for creating or updating an expense.
    Returns (cleaned_data, error_message).
    """
    if not isinstance(data, dict):
        return None, "Invalid JSON payload format"

    title = data.get("title")
    amount = data.get("amount")
    category = data.get("category")
    expense_date = data.get("date")
    notes = data.get("notes", "")

    # Title validation
    if title is None or not str(title).strip():
        return None, "Expense title is required"
    title = str(title).strip()
    if len(title) > 120:
        return None, "Title must be 120 characters or less"

    # Amount validation
    if amount is None:
        return None, "Expense amount is required"
    try:
        amount = float(amount)
        if amount <= 0:
            return None, "Amount must be a positive number greater than 0"
        if amount > 10000000000:
            return None, "Amount exceeds maximum limit"
    except (TypeError, ValueError):
        return None, "Amount must be a valid numeric value"

    # Category validation
    if not category or category not in CATEGORIES:
        return None, f"Category must be one of: {', '.join(CATEGORIES)}"

    # Date validation (YYYY-MM-DD format)
    if not expense_date:
        expense_date = datetime.today().strftime("%Y-%m-%d")
    else:
        try:
            parsed_date = datetime.strptime(str(expense_date), "%Y-%m-%d")
            expense_date = parsed_date.strftime("%Y-%m-%d")
        except ValueError:

```



```

        return None, "Date must be in valid YYYY-MM-DD format"

# Notes validation
if notes is not None:
    notes = str(notes).strip()
    if len(notes) > 500:
        return None, "Notes must be 500 characters or less"
else:
    notes = ""

cleaned = {
    "title": title,
    "amount": round(amount, 2),
    "category": category,
    "date": expense_date,
    "notes": notes
}
return cleaned, None

def validate_recurring_data(data):
    """
    Validates input fields for creating a recurring expense.
    """
    cleaned, error = validate_expense_data(data)
    if error:
        return None, error

    frequency = data.get("frequency")
    if not frequency or frequency not in FREQUENCIES:
        return None, f"Frequency must be one of: {'', '.join(FREQUENCIES)}"

    cleaned["frequency"] = frequency
    cleaned["next_date"] = cleaned["date"] # start date becomes next_date
    return cleaned, None

def add_frequency(dt_date, freq):
    if freq == "Daily":
        return dt_date + timedelta(days=1)
    if freq == "Weekly":
        return dt_date + timedelta(days=7)
    if freq == "Monthly":
        month = dt_date.month - 1 + 1
        year = dt_date.year + month // 12
        month = month % 12 + 1
        day = min(dt_date.day, [31,
                                29 if year%4==0 and (not year%100==0 or year%400==0) else 28,
                                31, 30, 31, 30, 31, 31, 30, 31, 30, 31][month-1])
        return dt_date.replace(year=year, month=month, day=day)
    if freq == "Yearly":
        year = dt_date.year + 1
        day = min(dt_date.day, [31,
                                29 if year%4==0 and (not year%100==0 or year%400==0) else 28,
                                31, 30, 31, 30, 31, 31, 30, 31, 30, 31][dt_date.month-1])
        return dt_date.replace(year=year, day=day)

```

```
    return dt_date
```

```
@app.route("/api/health", methods=["GET"])
```

```
def health_check():
```

```
    """Health check endpoint for monitoring system status."""
```

```
    try:
```

```
        conn = get_db_connection()
```

```
        conn.execute("SELECT 1").fetchone()
```

```
        conn.close()
```

```
        db_status = "healthy"
```

```
    except Exception:
```

```
        db_status = "unhealthy"
```

```
    return make_response(
```

```
        success=True,
```

```
        data={
```

```
            "status": "online",
```

```
            "database": db_status,
```

```
            "timestamp": datetime.utcnow().isoformat() + "Z",
```

```
            "version": "3.0.0"
```

```
        }
```

```
    )
```

```
@app.route("/api/auth/register", methods=["POST"])
```

```
def register():
```

```
    data = request.get_json(silent=True)
```

```
    if not data or not data.get("email") or not data.get("password"):
```

```
        return make_response(success=False, error="Email and password required", code=400)
```

```
    email = data["email"].strip().lower()
```

```
    password = data["password"]
```

```
    try:
```

```
        conn = get_db_connection()
```

```
        existing = conn.execute("SELECT id FROM users WHERE email = ?", (email,)).fetchone()
```

```
        if existing:
```

```
            conn.close()
```

```
            return make_response(success=False, error="Email already registered", code=400)
```

```
        pwd_hash = generate_password_hash(password)
```

```
        conn.execute(
```

```
            "INSERT INTO users (email, password_hash, created_at) VALUES (?, ?, ?)",
```

```
            (email, pwd_hash, datetime.utcnow().isoformat())
```

```
        )
```

```
        conn.commit()
```

```
        conn.close()
```

```
        return make_response(success=True, message="User registered successfully", code=201)
```

```
    except sqlite3.Error:
```

```
        return make_response(success=False, error="Database error", code=500)
```

```
@app.route("/api/auth/login", methods=["POST"])
```

```
def login():
```

```
    data = request.get_json(silent=True)
```

```
    if not data or not data.get("email") or not data.get("password"):
```

```

        return make_response(success=False, error="Email and password required", code=400)

    email = data["email"].strip().lower()
    password = data["password"]

    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()
        user = conn.execute("SELECT id, email, password_hash FROM users WHERE email = ?",
(email,)).fetchone()
        conn.close()

        if not user or not check_password_hash(user["password_hash"], password):
            return make_response(success=False, error="Invalid email or password", code=401)

        token = jwt.encode({
            "user_id": user["id"],
            "exp": datetime.utcnow() + timedelta(days=7)
        }, app.config['SECRET_KEY'], algorithm="HS256")

        return make_response(success=True, data={"token": token, "email": user["email"]},
message="Login successful")
    except Exception as e:
        return make_response(success=False, error="Login failed", code=500)

@app.route("/api/auth/me", methods=["GET"])
@token_required
def get_me(current_user_id):
    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()
        user = conn.execute("SELECT id, email, created_at FROM users WHERE id = ?",
(current_user_id,)).fetchone()
        conn.close()
        if not user:
            return make_response(success=False, error="User not found", code=404)
        return make_response(success=True, data=dict(user))
    except sqlite3.Error:
        return make_response(success=False, error="Database error", code=500)

@app.route("/api/categories", methods=["GET"])
@token_required
def get_categories(current_user_id):
    """Return list of valid expense categories."""
    return make_response(success=True, data=CATEGORIES)

@app.route("/api/expenses", methods=["GET"])
@token_required
def get_expenses(current_user_id):
    """
    Return expense records with support for search, category filtering,
    date range filtering, sorting, and pagination.
    """
    category = request.args.get("category")
    start = request.args.get("start")
    end = request.args.get("end")

```

```

search = request.args.get("search")
sort_by = request.args.get("sort_by", "date")
order = request.args.get("order", "desc").lower()

# Pagination parameters
try:
    page = int(request.args.get("page", 1))
    if page < 1:
        page = 1
except ValueError:
    page = 1

try:
    limit = int(request.args.get("limit", 20))
    if limit < 1:
        limit = 20
    elif limit > 500:
        limit = 500
except ValueError:
    limit = 20

query = "SELECT * FROM expenses WHERE user_id = ?"
count_query = "SELECT COUNT(*) as total FROM expenses WHERE user_id = ?"
params = [current_user_id]

if category and category != "All":
    query += " AND category = ?"
    count_query += " AND category = ?"
    params.append(category)

if start:
    query += " AND date >= ?"
    count_query += " AND date >= ?"
    params.append(start)

if end:
    query += " AND date <= ?"
    count_query += " AND date <= ?"
    params.append(end)

if search:
    search_pattern = f"%{search.strip()}%"
    query += " AND (title LIKE ? OR notes LIKE ?)"
    count_query += " AND (title LIKE ? OR notes LIKE ?)"
    params.extend([search_pattern, search_pattern])

# Validate sort field to prevent SQL injection
valid_sort_fields = {"date": "date", "amount": "amount", "title": "title", "category":
"category"}
sort_column = valid_sort_fields.get(sort_by, "date")
sort_order = "ASC" if order == "asc" else "DESC"

# Secondary sort by id for deterministic pagination
query += f" ORDER BY {sort_column} {sort_order}, id {sort_order}"

# Calculate pagination offset

```

```

offset = (page - 1) * limit
query += " LIMIT ? OFFSET ?"
query_params = list(params) + [limit, offset]

try:
    conn = get_db_connection()
    total_records = conn.execute(count_query, params).fetchone()["total"]
    rows = conn.execute(query, query_params).fetchall()
    conn.close()

    items = [dict(row) for row in rows]
    total_pages = (total_records + limit - 1) // limit if total_records > 0 else 1

    return make_response(
        success=True,
        data=items,
        pagination={
            "page": page,
            "limit": limit,
            "total_count": total_records,
            "total_pages": total_pages
        }
    )
except sqlite3.Error as e:
    return make_response(success=False, error="Database query failed", code=500)

@app.route("/api/expenses/<int:expense_id>", methods=["GET"])
@token_required
def get_expense(current_user_id, expense_id):
    """Retrieve details of a single expense."""
    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()
        row = conn.execute("SELECT * FROM expenses WHERE id = ? AND user_id = ?", (expense_id,
current_user_id)).fetchone()
        conn.close()

        if not row:
            return make_response(success=False, error="Expense not found", code=404)

        return make_response(success=True, data=dict(row))
    except sqlite3.Error:
        return make_response(success=False, error="Failed to fetch expense details", code=500)

@app.route("/api/expenses", methods=["POST"])
@token_required
def add_expense(current_user_id):
    """Create a new expense with strict input validation."""
    data = request.get_json(silent=True)
    cleaned, error = validate_expense_data(data)
    if error:
        return make_response(success=False, error=error, code=400)

    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()

```

```

        cur = conn.execute(
            "INSERT INTO expenses (user_id, title, amount, category, date, notes) VALUES (?, ?, ?,
?, ?, ?)",
            (current_user_id, cleaned["title"], cleaned["amount"], cleaned["category"],
cleaned["date"], cleaned["notes"]),
        )
        conn.commit()
        new_id = cur.lastrowid
        conn.close()

        cleaned["id"] = new_id
        return make_response(success=True, data=cleaned, message="Expense recorded successfully",
code=201)
    except sqlite3.Error:
        return make_response(success=False, error="Failed to insert expense into database",
code=500)

@app.route("/api/expenses/<int:expense_id>", methods=["PUT"])
@token_required
def update_expense(current_user_id, expense_id):
    """Update an existing expense with strict input validation."""
    data = request.get_json(silent=True)
    cleaned, error = validate_expense_data(data, is_update=True)
    if error:
        return make_response(success=False, error=error, code=400)

    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()
        existing = conn.execute("SELECT id FROM expenses WHERE id = ? AND user_id = ?", (expense_id,
current_user_id)).fetchone()
        if not existing:
            conn.close()
            return make_response(success=False, error="Expense not found", code=404)

        conn.execute(
            "UPDATE expenses SET title=?, amount=?, category=?, date=?, notes=? WHERE id=? AND
user_id=?",
            (cleaned["title"], cleaned["amount"], cleaned["category"], cleaned["date"],
cleaned["notes"], expense_id, current_user_id),
        )
        conn.commit()
        conn.close()

        cleaned["id"] = expense_id
        return make_response(success=True, data=cleaned, message="Expense updated successfully")
    except sqlite3.Error:
        return make_response(success=False, error="Failed to update expense in database", code=500)

@app.route("/api/expenses/<int:expense_id>", methods=["DELETE"])
@token_required
def delete_expense(current_user_id, expense_id):
    """Delete an expense record by ID."""
    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()

```

```

        existing = conn.execute("SELECT id FROM expenses WHERE id = ? AND user_id = ?", (expense_id,
current_user_id)).fetchone()
        if not existing:
            conn.close()
            return make_response(success=False, error="Expense not found", code=404)

        conn.execute("DELETE FROM expenses WHERE id = ? AND user_id = ?", (expense_id,
current_user_id))
        conn.commit()
        conn.close()

        return make_response(success=True, message="Expense deleted successfully")
    except sqlite3.Error:
        return make_response(success=False, error="Failed to delete expense from database",
code=500)

@app.route("/api/summary", methods=["GET"])
@token_required
def get_summary(current_user_id):
    """
    Provide aggregated statistics, category breakdown, monthly trends, weekly trends,
    and smart narrative insights for the dashboard.
    """
    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()

        # Overall Totals
        totals = conn.execute(
            "SELECT COUNT(*) as count, COALESCE(SUM(amount), 0) as total, COALESCE(MAX(amount), 0)
as max_amount, COALESCE(AVG(amount), 0) as avg_amount FROM expenses WHERE user_id = ?",
            (current_user_id,)
        ).fetchone()

        income_totals = conn.execute(
            "SELECT COALESCE(SUM(amount), 0) as total_income FROM incomes WHERE user_id = ?",
            (current_user_id,)
        ).fetchone()
        total_income = income_totals["total_income"] if income_totals else 0.0
        balance = total_income - totals["total"]

        # Category Breakdown
        by_category = conn.execute(
            """SELECT category, COALESCE(SUM(amount), 0) as total, COUNT(*) as count
            FROM expenses WHERE user_id = ? GROUP BY category ORDER BY total DESC""",
            (current_user_id,)
        ).fetchall()

        # Budgets Utilization
        budgets_raw = conn.execute(
            "SELECT id, category, limit_amount FROM budgets WHERE user_id = ?",
            (current_user_id,)
        ).fetchall()

        # Map expenses by category for quick lookup
        spent_by_cat = {row["category"]: row["total"] for row in by_category}

```

```

budgets = []
for b in budgets_raw:
    spent = spent_by_cat.get(b["category"], 0.0)
    budgets.append({
        "id": b["id"],
        "category": b["category"],
        "limit_amount": b["limit_amount"],
        "spent_amount": spent,
        "utilization_pct": round((spent / b["limit_amount"]) * 100, 1) if b["limit_amount"]
> 0 else 0
    })

# Monthly Trends (last 12 months)
by_month = conn.execute(
    """SELECT strftime('%Y-%m', date) as month, COALESCE(SUM(amount), 0) as total, COUNT(*)
as count
    FROM expenses WHERE user_id = ? GROUP BY month ORDER BY month ASC LIMIT 12""",
    (current_user_id,)
).fetchall()

# Weekly Trends (last 8 weeks)
by_week = conn.execute(
    """SELECT strftime('%Y-%W', date) as week, MIN(date) as week_start,
COALESCE(SUM(amount), 0) as total
    FROM expenses WHERE user_id = ? GROUP BY week ORDER BY week ASC LIMIT 8""",
    (current_user_id,)
).fetchall()

# Current vs Previous Month spending calculation
now = datetime.today()
current_month_str = now.strftime("%Y-%m")
prev_month_date = (now.replace(day=1) - timedelta(days=1))
prev_month_str = prev_month_date.strftime("%Y-%m")

current_month_row = conn.execute(
    "SELECT COALESCE(SUM(amount), 0) as total FROM expenses WHERE user_id = ? AND
strftime('%Y-%m', date) = ?",
    (current_user_id, current_month_str)
).fetchone()
current_month_spent = current_month_row["total"] if current_month_row else 0.0

prev_month_row = conn.execute(
    "SELECT COALESCE(SUM(amount), 0) as total FROM expenses WHERE user_id = ? AND
strftime('%Y-%m', date) = ?",
    (current_user_id, prev_month_str)
).fetchone()
prev_month_spent = prev_month_row["total"] if prev_month_row else 0.0

# Percentage change
if prev_month_spent > 0:
    month_change_pct = round(((current_month_spent - prev_month_spent) / prev_month_spent) *
100, 1)
elif current_month_spent > 0:
    month_change_pct = 100.0
else:
    month_change_pct = 0.0

```



```

# Recent 5 expenses
recent = conn.execute(
    "SELECT * FROM expenses WHERE user_id = ? ORDER BY date DESC, id DESC LIMIT 5",
    (current_user_id,)
).fetchall()

conn.close()

# Generate Dynamic Smart Insights
insights = []
if totals["count"] > 0:
    # 1. Month comparison insight
    if prev_month_spent > 0:
        if month_change_pct > 0:
            insights.append(f"You spent {abs(month_change_pct)}% more this month compared to last month.")
        elif month_change_pct < 0:
            insights.append(f"Great job! Your spending is down {abs(month_change_pct)}% this month compared to last month.")
        else:
            insights.append("Your spending this month is equal to last month's total.")

    # 2. Top category insight
    if by_category:
        top_cat = by_category[0]
        pct_share = round((top_cat["total"] / totals["total"]) * 100, 1) if totals["total"]
> 0 else 0
        insights.append(f"{top_cat['category']} is your highest spending category ({pct_share}% of total spent).")

    # 3. Average transaction insight
    if totals["avg_amount"] > 0:
        insights.append(f"Your average expense transaction is ₹{totals['avg_amount']:,.2f}.")

summary_data = {
    "totalIncome": round(total_income, 2),
    "balance": round(balance, 2),
    "totalSpent": round(totals["total"], 2),
    "totalCount": totals["count"],
    "avgExpense": round(totals["avg_amount"], 2),
    "maxExpense": round(totals["max_amount"], 2),
    "currentMonthSpent": round(current_month_spent, 2),
    "prevMonthSpent": round(prev_month_spent, 2),
    "monthChangePct": month_change_pct,
    "topCategory": by_category[0]["category"] if by_category else None,
    "byCategory": [dict(r) for r in by_category],
    "byMonth": [dict(r) for r in by_month],
    "byWeek": [dict(r) for r in by_week],
    "recent": [dict(r) for r in recent],
    "budgets": budgets,
    "insights": insights
}

return make_response(success=True, data=summary_data)

```

```

except sqlite3.Error as e:
    return make_response(success=False, error="Failed to generate summary statistics", code=500)

@app.route("/api/expenses/export", methods=["GET"])
@token_required
def export_csv(current_user_id):
    """Export expense records as a downloadable CSV file."""
    category = request.args.get("category")
    start = request.args.get("start")
    end = request.args.get("end")
    search = request.args.get("search")

    query = "SELECT id, date, title, category, amount, notes FROM expenses WHERE user_id = ?"
    params = [current_user_id]

    if category and category != "All":
        query += " AND category = ?"
        params.append(category)
    if start:
        query += " AND date >= ?"
        params.append(start)
    if end:
        query += " AND date <= ?"
        params.append(end)
    if search:
        search_pattern = f"%{search.strip()}%"
        query += " AND (title LIKE ? OR notes LIKE ?)"
        params.extend([search_pattern, search_pattern])

    query += " ORDER BY date DESC, id DESC"

    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()
        rows = conn.execute(query, params).fetchall()
        conn.close()

        output = io.StringIO()
        writer = csv.writer(output)

        # Write header row
        writer.writerow(["ID", "Date", "Title", "Category", "Amount (INR)", "Notes"])

        # Write data rows
        for row in rows:
            writer.writerow([row["id"], row["date"], row["title"], row["category"],
f"{row['amount']:.2f}", row["notes"]])

        csv_content = output.getvalue()
        output.close()

        filename = f"ledger_expenses_{datetime.now().strftime('%Y%m%d_%H%M%S')}.csv"
        return Response(
            csv_content,
            mimetype="text/csv",
            headers={"Content-Disposition": f"attachment; filename={filename}"})

```

```

    )
except sqlite3.Error:
    return make_response(success=False, error="Failed to export CSV file", code=500)

@app.route("/api/recurring", methods=["GET"])
@token_required
def get_recurring_expenses(current_user_id):
    """List all recurring expense templates."""
    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()
        rows = conn.execute("SELECT * FROM recurring_expenses WHERE user_id = ? ORDER BY id DESC",
(current_user_id,)).fetchall()
        conn.close()
        return make_response(success=True, data=[dict(r) for r in rows])
    except sqlite3.Error:
        return make_response(success=False, error="Database query failed", code=500)

@app.route("/api/recurring", methods=["POST"])
@token_required
def add_recurring_expense(current_user_id):
    """Create a new recurring expense template."""
    data = request.get_json(silent=True)
    cleaned, error = validate_recurring_data(data)
    if error:
        return make_response(success=False, error=error, code=400)

    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()
        cur = conn.execute(
            "INSERT INTO recurring_expenses (user_id, title, amount, category, frequency, next_date,
notes) VALUES (?, ?, ?, ?, ?, ?, ?)",
            (current_user_id, cleaned["title"], cleaned["amount"], cleaned["category"],
cleaned["frequency"], cleaned["next_date"], cleaned["notes"]),
        )
        conn.commit()
        new_id = cur.lastrowid
        conn.close()

        cleaned["id"] = new_id
        return make_response(success=True, data=cleaned, message="Recurring expense created
successfully", code=201)
    except sqlite3.Error:
        return make_response(success=False, error="Failed to insert into database", code=500)

@app.route("/api/recurring/<int:recurring_id>", methods=["DELETE"])
@token_required
def delete_recurring_expense(current_user_id, recurring_id):
    """Delete a recurring expense."""
    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()
        existing = conn.execute("SELECT id FROM recurring_expenses WHERE id = ? AND user_id = ?",
(recurring_id, current_user_id)).fetchone()
        if not existing:

```

```

        conn.close()
        return make_response(success=False, error="Recurring expense not found", code=404)

    conn.execute("DELETE FROM recurring_expenses WHERE id = ? AND user_id = ?", (recurring_id,
current_user_id))
    conn.commit()
    conn.close()
    return make_response(success=True, message="Recurring expense deleted successfully")
except sqlite3.Error:
    return make_response(success=False, error="Failed to delete from database", code=500)

@app.route("/api/recurring/process", methods=["POST"])
@token_required
def process_recurring_expenses(current_user_id):
    """Check for due recurring expenses, insert them, and update their next_date."""
    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()
        today_str = datetime.today().strftime("%Y-%m-%d")

        due_expenses = conn.execute(
            "SELECT * FROM recurring_expenses WHERE user_id = ? AND next_date <= ?",
            (current_user_id, today_str)
        ).fetchall()

        processed_count = 0
        for req in due_expenses:
            current_date_str = req["next_date"]
            current_date = datetime.strptime(current_date_str, "%Y-%m-%d").date()
            today_date = datetime.strptime(today_str, "%Y-%m-%d").date()

            while current_date <= today_date:
                conn.execute(
                    "INSERT INTO expenses (user_id, title, amount, category, date, notes) VALUES (?,
?, ?, ?, ?, ?)",
                    (current_user_id, req["title"], req["amount"], req["category"],
current_date.strftime("%Y-%m-%d"), req["notes"])
                )
                processed_count += 1
                current_date = add_frequency(current_date, req["frequency"])

            conn.execute(
                "UPDATE recurring_expenses SET next_date = ? WHERE id = ? AND user_id = ?",
                (current_date.strftime("%Y-%m-%d"), req["id"], current_user_id)
            )

        conn.commit()
        conn.close()

        return make_response(success=True, message=f"Processed {processed_count} recurring
expenses.")
    except sqlite3.Error as e:
        return make_response(success=False, error=str(e), code=500)

def validate_income_data(data):

```

```

if not isinstance(data, dict): return None, "Invalid format"
source = data.get("source")
amount = data.get("amount")
inc_date = data.get("date")
notes = data.get("notes", "")

if not source or not str(source).strip(): return None, "Source is required"
if amount is None: return None, "Amount is required"
try:
    amount = float(amount)
    if amount <= 0: return None, "Amount must be > 0"
except: return None, "Invalid amount"

if not inc_date: inc_date = datetime.today().strftime("%Y-%m-%d")
return {"source": str(source).strip(), "amount": round(amount, 2), "date": inc_date, "notes":
str(notes).strip()[:500]}, None

@app.route("/api/incomes", methods=["GET"])
@token_required
def get_incomes(current_user_id):
    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()
        rows = conn.execute("SELECT * FROM incomes WHERE user_id = ? ORDER BY date DESC, id DESC",
(current_user_id,)).fetchall()
        conn.close()
        return make_response(success=True, data=[dict(r) for r in rows])
    except sqlite3.Error:
        return make_response(success=False, error="DB error", code=500)

@app.route("/api/incomes", methods=["POST"])
@token_required
def add_income(current_user_id):
    data = request.get_json(silent=True)
    cleaned, err = validate_income_data(data)
    if err: return make_response(success=False, error=err, code=400)
    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()
        cur = conn.execute("INSERT INTO incomes (user_id, source, amount, date, notes) VALUES (?, ?,
?, ?, ?)",
        (current_user_id, cleaned["source"], cleaned["amount"], cleaned["date"],
cleaned["notes"]))
        conn.commit()
        cleaned["id"] = cur.lastrowid
        conn.close()
        return make_response(success=True, data=cleaned, message="Income added", code=201)
    except sqlite3.Error:
        return make_response(success=False, error="DB error", code=500)

@app.route("/api/incomes/<int:inc_id>", methods=["DELETE"])
@token_required
def delete_income(current_user_id, inc_id):
    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()
        conn.execute("DELETE FROM incomes WHERE id = ? AND user_id = ?", (inc_id, current_user_id))
        conn.commit()
        conn.close()

```

```

        return make_response(success=True, message="Income deleted")
    except sqlite3.Error:
        return make_response(success=False, error="DB error", code=500)

def validate_budget_data(data):
    if not isinstance(data, dict): return None, "Invalid format"
    category = data.get("category")
    limit = data.get("limit_amount")

    if not category or category not in CATEGORIES: return None, "Valid category is required"
    if limit is None: return None, "Limit amount is required"
    try:
        limit = float(limit)
        if limit <= 0: return None, "Limit must be > 0"
    except: return None, "Invalid amount"

    return {"category": category, "limit_amount": round(limit, 2)}, None

@app.route("/api/budgets", methods=["GET"])
@token_required
def get_budgets(current_user_id):
    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()
        rows = conn.execute("SELECT * FROM budgets WHERE user_id = ?",
(current_user_id,)).fetchall()
        conn.close()
        return make_response(success=True, data=[dict(r) for r in rows])
    except sqlite3.Error:
        return make_response(success=False, error="DB error", code=500)

@app.route("/api/budgets", methods=["POST"])
@token_required
def add_budget(current_user_id):
    data = request.get_json(silent=True)
    cleaned, err = validate_budget_data(data)
    if err: return make_response(success=False, error=err, code=400)
    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()
        # Ensure category isn't already budgeted for this user
        existing = conn.execute("SELECT id FROM budgets WHERE user_id = ? AND category = ?",
(current_user_id, cleaned["category"])).fetchone()
        if existing:
            conn.execute("UPDATE budgets SET limit_amount = ? WHERE id = ?",
(cleaned["limit_amount"], existing["id"]))
            conn.commit()
            cleaned["id"] = existing["id"]
        else:
            cur = conn.execute("INSERT INTO budgets (user_id, category, limit_amount) VALUES (?, ?,
)?",
                (current_user_id, cleaned["category"], cleaned["limit_amount"]))
            conn.commit()
            cleaned["id"] = cur.lastrowid
        conn.close()
        return make_response(success=True, data=cleaned, message="Budget saved", code=201)
    except sqlite3.Error:

```

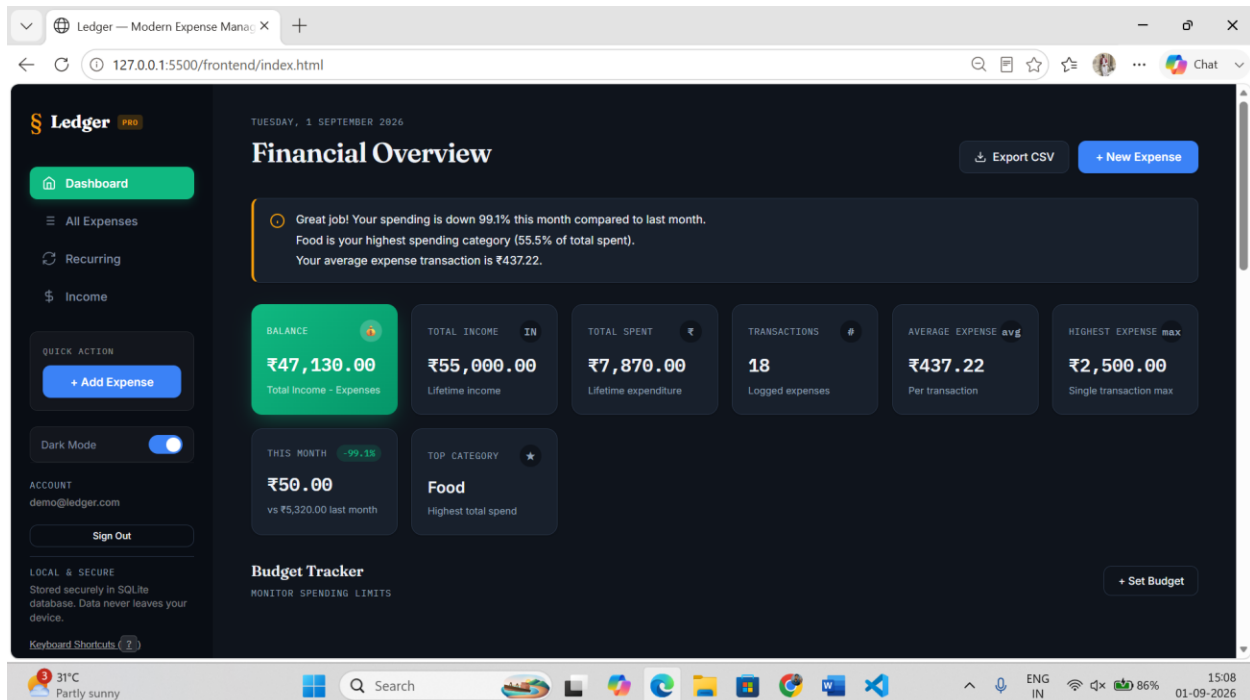
```

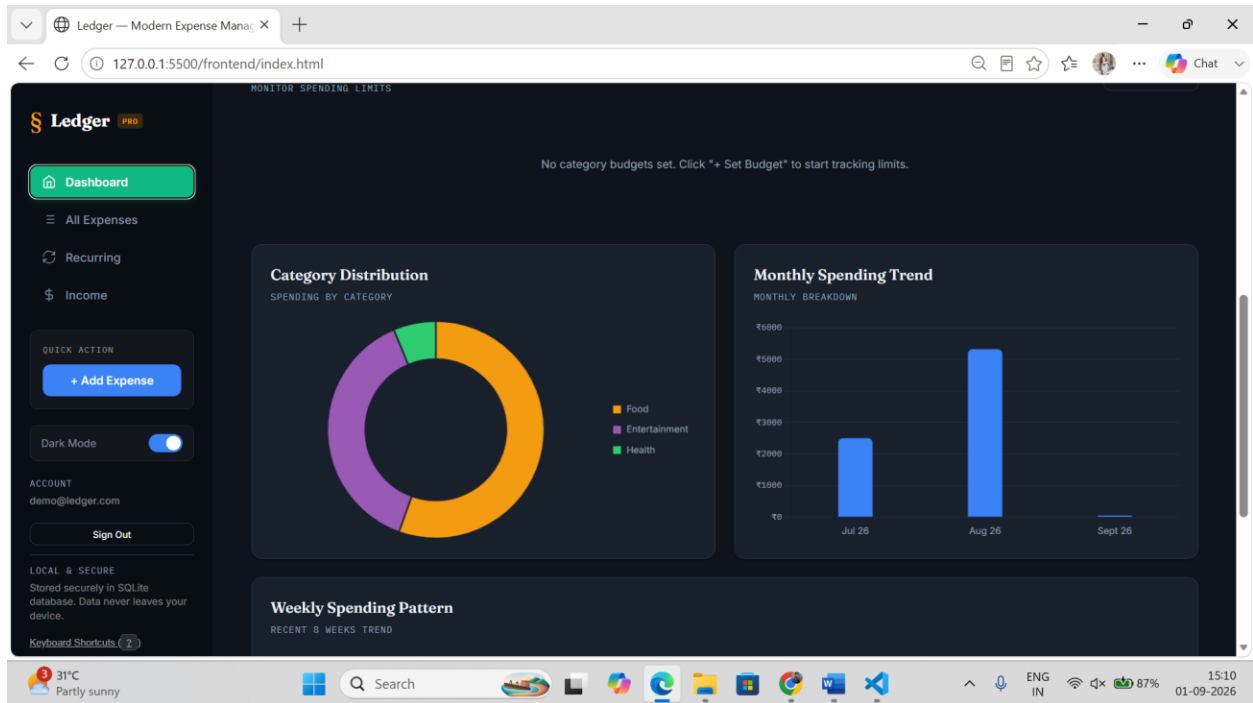
        return make_response(success=False, error="DB error", code=500)

@app.route("/api/budgets/<int:bg_id>", methods=["DELETE"])
@token_required
def delete_budget(current_user_id, bg_id):
    try:
        conn = get_db_connection()
        conn.execute("DELETE FROM budgets WHERE id = ? AND user_id = ?", (bg_id, current_user_id))
        conn.commit()
        conn.close()
        return make_response(success=True, message="Budget deleted")
    except sqlite3.Error:
        return make_response(success=False, error="DB error", code=500)

if __name__ == "__main__":
    init_db()
    print("=====")
    print(" Ledger Expense Management Dashboard Backend API")
    print(" Running at: http://127.0.0.1:5000")
    print(" Health check: http://127.0.0.1:5000/api/health")
    print("=====")
    app.run(debug=True, port=5000)

```





Ledger — Modern Expense Manager

127.0.0.1:5500/frontend/index.html

Ledger

Dashboard

All Expenses

Recurring

Income

QUICK ACTION

+ Add Expense

Dark Mode

ACCOUNT

demo@ledger.com

Sign Out

LOCAL & SECURE

Stored securely in SQLite database. Data never leaves your device.

Keyboard Shortcuts

TUESDAY, 1 SEPTEMBER 2026

Expense Records

Export CSV + New Expense

Search title or notes... (Press '/' to focus)

All Categories dd-mm-yyyy to dd-mm-yyyy Sort by Date Descending Clear Export CSV

DATE	TITLE & NOTES	CATEGORY	AMOUNT	ACTIONS
Today	Daily Coffee Test recurring	Food	₹50.00	👁️ 📝 🗑️
Yesterday	Daily Coffee Test recurring	Food	₹50.00	👁️ 📝 🗑️
30 Aug 2026	Daily Coffee Test recurring	Food	₹50.00	👁️ 📝 🗑️
29 Aug 2026	Daily Coffee Test recurring	Food	₹50.00	👁️ 📝 🗑️
28 Aug 2026	Daily Coffee Test recurring	Food	₹50.00	👁️ 📝 🗑️

Ledger

Dashboard

All Expenses

Recurring

Income

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Keyboard Shortcuts

TUESDAY, 1 SEPTEMBER 2026

Recurring Expenses

Export CSV

New Expense

Active Subscriptions & Recurring Bills

New Recurring

TITLE & NOTES	CATEGORY	FREQUENCY	NEXT DUE	AMOUNT	ACTIONS
Daily Coffee Test recurring	Food	Daily	02 Sept 2026	₹50.00	

31°C
Partly sunny

Search

ENG IN

88%

15:11
01-09-2026

Ledger

Dashboard

All Expenses

Recurring

Income

QUICK ACTION

+ Add Expense

Dark Mode

ACCOUNT

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LOCAL & SECURE

Stored securely in SQLite database. Data never leaves your device.

Keyboard Shortcuts

TUESDAY, 1 SEPTEMBER 2026

Income Management

Export CSV

New Expense

Income Sources

Add Income

DATE	SOURCE & NOTES	AMOUNT	ACTIONS
27 Aug 2026	class	+₹30,000.00	
27 Aug 2026	freelance	+₹25,000.00	

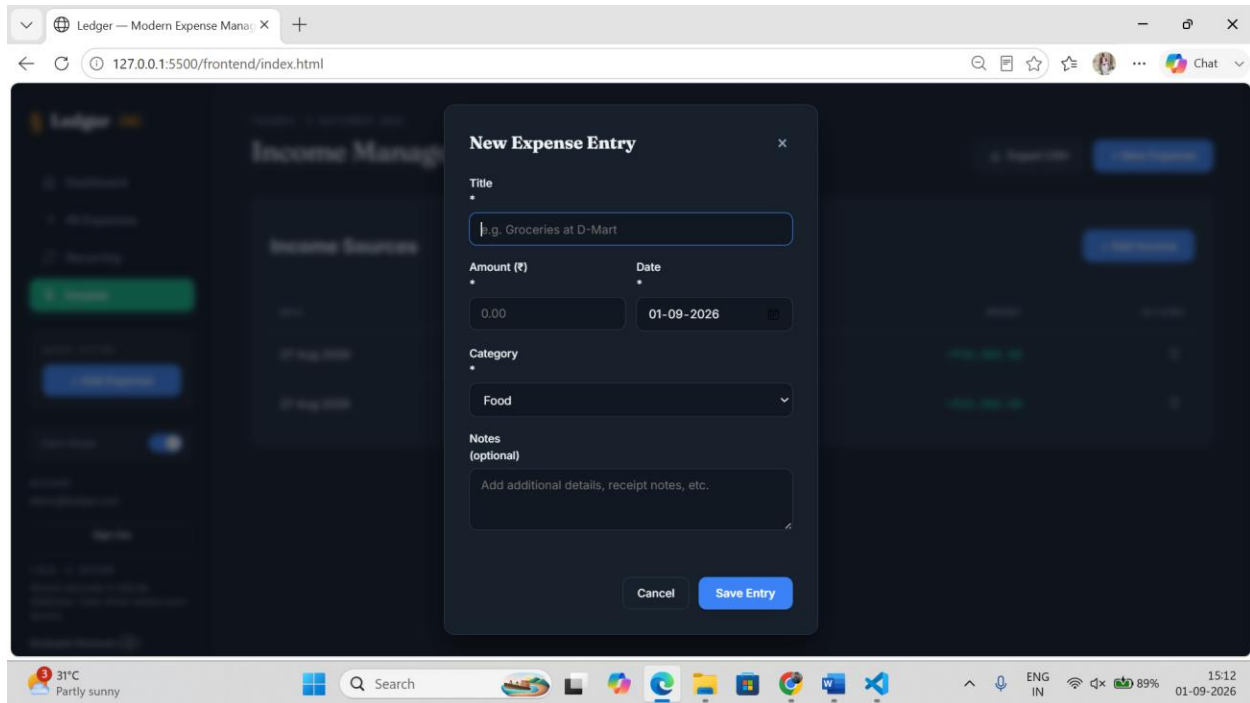
31°C
Partly sunny

Search

ENG IN

88%

15:11
01-09-2026



Appendix B: Technical Deployment & Quick Start Manual

1. Clone project repository

```
git clone https://github.com/ledger/ledger-expense-tracker.git
cd ledger-expense-tracker
```

2. Initialize and activate Python virtual environment

```
python3 -m venv venv
source venv/bin/activate # On Windows: venv\Scripts\activate
```

3. Install dependencies

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

4. Start the Flask Backend Server

```
python app.py
```

Server active on <http://127.0.0.1:5000> -> Open index.html in browser